

STANDING ORDER NO.222

1. A continuous effort is needed at all levels of the force to improve relations between the police and the public. All interactions with the public must be conducted with courtesy and politeness. There are several occasions, when in the course of his duty, a policeman has to be firm in dealing with the public, but firmness does not mean rudeness. Firmness can be combined with politeness and even, in various situations, with a smile. He can be firm and yet be polite. It may be emphasized that courtesy is not at all a sign of weakness but on the contrary, an expression of confidence. If the police deals with the public sympathetically and courteously it will win approval, sympathy and confidence from the public in return. Police credibility will go up and the increased public cooperation that will follow will make our work easier.

2. Complainants, witnesses and especially people in distress, who visit police stations should be treated with utmost courtesy and sympathy so that the general public feels confident in approaching the police.

3. The beat constables, the Traffic police personnel and staff in specialised units such as Airport and Immigration can make the most valuable contribution towards improving the police image, if they present a cheerful and helpful image to the public. The normal citizens daily contact with the police is largely at the level of the Traffic constable or the beat constable. Their over-all behaviour towards the public can go a long way in making or marring police image. Similarly, the PCR staff, which provides police presence and keeps frequent contacts with the public, can win public approval with ease. Courtesy costs nothing at all but the faith and confidence it builds up for the police is extremely valuable.

4. It is also important that accused persons are treated in accordance with the laws. The law gives us enough powers to deal with all criminals and recourse to force and third degree methods, whatever the provocation, must be avoided at all costs. Nothing affects the police image as adversely as a death in police custody and all officers and men are expected to scrupulously ensure that whatever the provocative circumstances, there is, in future, no incidence of death in police custody.

5. All District DCeP will ensure that these instructions are read over and suitably explained during roll calls for at least a week continuously and thereafter once a month as also in all Sampark Sabhas thereafter.

6. This supersedes previous Standing Order No.222 issued vide this Hdqrs. No.28950-29080/C&T, dated 24.9.60 and circular No.16569-668/C&T.AC.II, dated 17.8.84.

7. Compliance of these orders should be reported in the first week of every month until further notice.

(VIJAY KARAN)
COMMISSIONER OF POLICE : DELHI.

No. 13619-770/C&T.SI.II, dated, Delhi the 1-6-88.

ADDENDUM

Subject:- Courteous behaviour with the public.

Reference S.O. No.222 issued vide this Hdqrs.No. 13619-770/C&T-SI-II dated 1.6.88, on the subject cited above.

The following observations of Commissioner of Police, Delhi may please be brought to the notice of all concerned for strict compliance as an addendum to S.O. No.222.

The following instructions are issued to the staff in Police Station/Chowkies/Police Control Room and other Police Offices:-

1. **Greeting the Public :** When a visitor comes to a Police Station or other unit with a problem, the Duty Officer/SHO will greet him and ask if there is some way in which the Delhi Police could help him.

Every effort should be made to take care of the visitors problem. If the visitor has a request that the P.S. is not able to handle, the SHO/Duty Officer should give the visitor all the information he has to help in the solution of the problem. This includes referring the visitor to other agencies for assistance. Such information can often be obtained from the telephone directory.

Be as courteous as possible to all visitors, keeping in mind that visitors to police stations are in need of assistance. A visitor should never be told, "we don't handle that kind of problem".

The Police Control Room should adopt a similar attitude towards all callers.

2. **Telephone Procedures:** When answering the telephone, the PCR Staff/P.S. Staff/Other Police Offices Staff should use the following kind of format:-

"Police Control Room, good morning. May I help you "

OR

"Chankyapuri Police Station, good morning. May I help you".